INDIA TODAY SS
STATE OF THE STATE
CHHATTISGARH FIRST

▼ EMPOWERING WOMEN: THE ROAD AHEAD



"I was born in a Rajput family, so there was pressure not to shave my moustache or talk in a certain way. When I decided to turn from Vikas to Vidya, I knew there was no going back"

VIDYA RAJPUT,
Transgender activist

"Culturally and traditionally, women have always been at the forefront in Chhattisgarh. Women work shoulder to shoulder with men here"

KULISHA MISHRA,
Former State President, Jawahar Bal Manch

"At Uma Oils, 60-70 per cent of the workforce is women even though essential oils is a largely male-dominated industry"

BHOOMIKA UPADHYAY,
Founder, Uma Oils, Mahasamund

"When women come forward in politics, they do so not just for themselves but for the entire society. Reservation in local bodies has thrown up many women leaders"

DR. KIRANMAYEE NAYAK,
Chairperson, State Women's Commission, Chhattisgarh

▼ INVOKING CHHATTISGARHI PRIDE

"Our social identity inspires us to find more reasons why people should say *Chhattisgarhia sable badhiya*, instead of us saying it to ourselves"

RAHUL SINGH,
Archaeologist and culture expert



"In 2016, when I googled Chhattisgarhi recipes, I found nothing. I then took it upon myself to document lost Chhattisgarhi recipes"

KRITI SHARMA,
Chhattisgarhi cuisine expert



"For the first time, Chhattisgarhi identity is being taken to new heights through promotion of local sports, cuisine and festivals"

AMARJEET BHAGAT,
Chhattisgarh Culture Minister

